

LOVE, ACTUALLY... THE GAME: COMPLETE UI/UX DESIGN SPECIFICATION (UNIFIED COLOR SYSTEM)

I. UI/UX DESIGN PHILOSOPHY & CORE PRINCIPLES

1.1 The Non-Negotiable Premise

This app is couples therapy disguised as a retro arcade game show. Every pixel must communicate: "This is fun. This is competitive. This is where relationships level up."

1.2 Core Design Principles

1. Game-First, Therapy-Second: All therapeutic moments are gamified with points, levels, achievements
2. Couple-Centric Design: The couple is the primary "player" unit—design for shared progress
3. Mobile-First Arcade Experience: Optimized for portrait touch with thumb-accessible controls
4. Emotional Safety Through Play: Failure states are informative, not punitive
5. Dr. Marcie as Interactive Game Host: She's not a passive narrator—she participates in the UI
6. 3-Tap Navigation Rule: From any screen to core gameplay in 3 taps or less
7. Immediate Feedback: Every action gets visual, audio, and haptic response within 100ms

1.3 Information Hierarchy

- CRITICAL (Active Gameplay): Current challenge, partner input, Dr. Marcie feedback, timer
- IMPORTANT (Progress): Trust Thermometer, Daily Quest, Leaderboard, player stats

- SITUATIONAL (Management): Journal, settings, game library, historical data

1.4 Platform & Interaction Guidelines

- Primary: Mobile portrait touch (thumb-zone optimized)
 - Touch Targets: Minimum 44×44px, primary CTAs within thumb reach
 - Performance Targets: <2s load on 4G, 60fps animations, <5% battery per 30min
 - Error Recovery: Graceful degradation with clear recovery paths
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II. COMPREHENSIVE VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

2.1 Color Philosophy: Unified Emotional Language

Color is emotional choreography that flows seamlessly across the entire app. We use a unified system where gradients and accent colors coexist harmoniously, creating a consistent emotional language throughout all screens and games.

2.2 Master Color System

Core Gradients (Primary Emotional Anchors)

text

PRIMARY ACTION GRADIENT: #DB147C → #F05D68

- Emotional Weight: Warmth, action, courage, love
- Used for: Primary CTAs, important decisions, emotional confirmations
- Applied to: Buttons, important switches, key navigation elements

CONNECTION GRADIENT: #FCC738 → #EA031F → #C60AB3

- Emotional Weight: Energy, passion, human connection
- Used for: Avatar rings, partner indicators, connection status
- Applied to: Circular elements, relationship indicators, status rings

PROGRESS GRADIENT: #EF1B6E → #C41E77 → #A22AC4 → #9056EF

- Emotional Weight: Growth, depth, journey, emotional progress
- Used for: Progress bars, Trust Thermometer, XP bars, loading

- Applied to: Linear progress elements, growth indicators

10 Accent Colors (Emotional Vocabulary)

These colors flow freely throughout the app, appearing wherever emotional emphasis is needed.

text

#FC0C84 — VIBRANT PINK (Love, intensity, emotional hits)
#FF7600 — WARM ORANGE (Energy, excitement, playful alerts)
#FFEF1F — BRIGHT YELLOW (Joy, achievement, victory moments)
#37CF97 — MINT GREEN (Growth, safety, healing, positivity)
#B37DEC — SOFT VIOLET (Connection depth, mystery, calm intimacy)
#E16BA9 — ROSE PINK (Tenderness, romance, gentle moments)
#FF6B9D — BLUSH PINK (Playfulness, lightheartedness, fun)
#A16BF2 — LAVENDER PURPLE (Reflection, depth, thoughtful moments)
#00D4AA — AQUA TEAL (Clarity, insight, understanding)
#FF9E3D — PEACH ORANGE (Warmth, comfort, nurturing)

Background System (The Emotional Canvas)

text

#1A0B2E — DEEP COSMIC PURPLE (Primary background - emotional depth)
#2D1B45 — RICH PLUM (Card backgrounds - focus areas)
#3D2A5C — MID PURPLE (Game backgrounds - playful energy)
#0F0A1F — NIGHT SKY (Modal overlays - focus & intensity)
Input Field BG: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.05) with subtle gradient border
Divider Lines: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.08) with soft glow

2.3 Unified Color Application Rules

Rule 1: Gradients Define Importance

- Primary Actions: Always use Primary Action Gradient (#DB147C → #F05D68)
- Relationship Elements: Use Connection Gradient for circular/partner elements
- Progress Elements: Use Progress Gradient for all linear progress indicators

Rule 2: Accent Colors Create Emotional Rhythm

- Use all 10 accent colors throughout the entire app
- Distribute colors based on emotional context, not functional categories
- Colors can appear anywhere - buttons, text, icons, backgrounds, highlights
- Think of colors as an emotional vocabulary that speaks to different feelings

Rule 3: Backgrounds Set Emotional Tone

- Use Deep Cosmic Purple for most backgrounds
- Use Rich Plum for cards and focus areas
- Use Mid Purple for game-specific backgrounds
- Use Night Sky for modals and intense focus moments

Rule 4: Never Assign Fixed Meanings

- Colors don't mean specific things (✗ no green=good, red=bad)
- Colors create emotional atmosphere and rhythm
- The same color can mean different things in different contexts
- Focus on how colors make you feel, not what they "mean"

2.4 Component Color Examples

Game Screen with Unified Colors:

text

Jeopardy Board Example:

[Question 1: #FC0C84] [Question 2: #FF7600] [Question 3: #FFEF1F]

[Question 4: #37CF97] [Question 5: #B37DEC] [Question 6: #E16BA9]

BUTTONS ON SAME SCREEN:

[Submit Answer: #DB147C → #F05D68 Gradient]

[Hint Button: #A16BF2 Accent Color]

[Skip Button: #00D4AA Accent Color]

PROGRESS ON SAME SCREEN:

[XP Bar: #EF1B6E → #9056EF Gradient]

[Timer: #FF9E3D Accent Color with gradient track]

Profile Screen with Unified Colors:

text

AVATAR: Connection Gradient Ring (#FCC738 → #C60AB3)

TRUST METER: Progress Gradient Fill (#EF1B6E → #9056EF)

SETTINGS CARDS: Various accent colors for visual interest

PRIMARY BUTTONS: Primary Action Gradient (#DB147C → #F05D68)

SECONDARY BUTTONS: Accent colors based on function

2.5 Typography System

Font Family: Inter (Exclusively)

- Game Titles: Inter Black (900) - Arcade cabinet style
- Screen Headers: Inter Bold (700)
- Body Text: Inter Regular (400) - Optimized for quick mobile reading
- Button Text: Inter SemiBold (600), UPPERCASE, 16px minimum
- Dr. Marcie Dialogue: Inter Italic (400 italic) in speech bubbles
- Scores/Numbers: Inter Mono Medium (500) - Digital game feel
- Legal Text: Inter Regular (400), 14px minimum

Text Colors:

- Headlines: White (#FFFFFF) with subtle gradient overlay
- Body Text: #E2D9F3 (Light Lavender, 90% opacity)
- Accent Text: Use appropriate accent color for emphasis
- Gradient Text: Where emotionally impactful (limited use)
- Disabled: #6D5D8A (Muted Purple, 40% opacity)

2.6 Shadow & Glow System

- Soft Glow: rgba([accent color], 0.2) - Matches element color
- Medium Glow: rgba([accent color], 0.3) - For interactive states
- Strong Glow: rgba([accent color], 0.4) - For focused/active elements
- Rule: Glows always match the element's primary color

2.7 Iconography

- Style: Line icons with rounded ends, consistent stroke weight
 - Set: Feather Icons (custom colored to match palette)
 - Sizes: 24px (standard), 32px (large), 16px (small)
 - Color: Use appropriate accent color based on context and emotion
 - Interactive States: Color shifts to indicate state changes
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III. DR. MARCIE LISS: THE CONSISTENT GAME HOST

3.1 Character Consistency Rules (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

Visual Identity Lock:

- Hair: Always redheaded (signature crimson red)
- Style: 1950s noir detective meets retro arcade mascot
- Animation Style: Consistent character animation (never anime, never 2D flat)
- Core Design: Jessica Rabbit as a game show host with a psychology degree

What Can Change:

- Outfits: Different costumes (therapist lab coat, game show host, detective trenchcoat)
- Hair Style: Different updos, waves, or accessories
- Accessories: Different glasses, jewelry, props
- Expressions: Different emotional states within her character style

What NEVER Changes:

- Her red hair color
- Her core animation style (consistent character animation)
- Her 1950s noir detective aesthetic
- Her proportions and character design
- Her voice quality and tone (ElevenLabs consistent voice)

3.2 Overlay Behavior Rules

- Position: Fixed, z-index: 9999+ (always above UI)
- Never contained in boxes or frames
- Contextual Positioning: Adapts to current screen content
- Interaction: Physically interacts with UI elements (leans, points, taps)
- Visual Treatment: Can use any color from our palette for her UI elements

3.3 Contextual UI Interactions

text

ON INPUT FIELDS:

- Leans against field edge
- Taps clipboard while thinking
- Nods when typing vulnerably
- Shakes head at avoidant answers

ON BUTTONS:

- Points with gloved hand
- Pushes button with finger
- "Press me, I dare you" speech bubble

DURING TIMERS:

- Holds timer in hand
- Shows time on wristwatch
- Speeds up/slows down dramatically

DURING INACTIVITY:

- Taps watch impatiently
- Checks nails
- Sips virtual coffee
- "I'll wait..." speech bubble

ON GAME WINS:

- Confetti celebration
- Victory dance
- Finger guns + wink
- "Level up!" animation

ON GAME LOSSES:

- Facepalm animation
- Disappointed headshake
- "Try again, darling" encouragement
- Offers hint (if available)

3.4 Animation Library Integration

- Format: WebM with transparency, consistent character animation style
- Frame Rate: 60fps minimum
- Loading: <1s per animation

- 15+ Animations: All maintaining her core character design

3.5 Personality-Driven UI Changes

Level 1 (Tutorial): Gentle animations, warm colors in speech bubbles

Level 2 (Normal): Clinical precision, sharper animations

Level 3 (Hard): Poetic movements, intense visual feedback

Level 4 (Arcade): Dynamic blend, prophetic gestures, glamorous effects

Note: Personality changes affect her animations and dialogue, NOT her visual design.

IV. COMPONENT LIBRARY & SPECIFICATIONS

4.1 Game Elements with Unified Colors

Game Tiles/Cards:

- Size: 60×60px to 120×120px (scales proportionally)
- Border Radius: 16px (25% of height)
- Background: Can use any accent color or gradient based on emotional context
- Outline: 3px stroke (accent color or gradient)
- Glow: 8px blur, 0.3 opacity matching element color
- Text: Centered, Inter SemiBold, white when filled
- States: Smooth transition between states (200-300ms)

Progress Indicators:

- Track: Progress Gradient or accent color with lower opacity
- Fill: Progress Gradient or appropriate accent color
- Height: 8px standard, 12px for prominent displays
- Border Radius: 4px
- Animation: Smooth width transition + pulse on increment

Score Displays:

- Background: #2D1B45 with 20% opacity
- Text: Appropriate accent color based on context, Inter Mono Medium
- Animation: Scale up 110% → return + particle burst
- Particles: Use multiple accent colors for celebratory effect

4.2 Action Elements with Unified Colors

Primary Buttons:

- Size: Minimum 44×44px touch target
- Shape: Pill (16px radius)
- Fill: Primary Action Gradient (#DB147C → #F05D68) for main actions
- Text: Inter SemiBold, UPPERCASE, white, 16px minimum
- Pressed: 95% scale + 10% darker
- Shadow: Soft glow matching button color

Secondary Buttons:

- Fill: Appropriate accent color based on button purpose
- Examples:
 - Playful action: #FF7600 (Warm Orange)
 - Safe action: #37CF97 (Mint Green)
 - Romantic action: #E16BA9 (Rose Pink)
 - Reflective action: #A16BF2 (Lavender Purple)

Sliders (Intimacy Settings):

- Track: Progress Gradient or accent color gradient
- Thumb: 24×24px, glow effect using thumb color
- Labels: Inter Regular, Light Lavender or accent color
- Value Display: Current accent color, animated on change
- Dr. Marcie Interaction: Walks along track as user adjusts

Input Fields:

- Background: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.05)
- Border: Glow using current context color (gradient or accent)
- Text: Inter Regular, White
- Placeholder: Light Lavender, 60% opacity
- Focus: Border intensifies, Dr. Marcie leans on field
- Validation: Green (#37CF97) for valid, soft red for errors

4.3 Navigation Components

Bottom Navigation Tabs (7):

- Icons: 24px, current accent color when active

- Labels: Inter Regular, 12px, white when active
- Active Indicator: Small dot above icon using button gradient
- Background: #1A0B2E with subtle top border glow
- Order: HOME, GAMES, SOS, TRANSLATOR, LOVE ARCADE, ROMANCE HUB, PROFILE

Floating Action Buttons:

- SOS Button: ∞♥ icon, gradient red, bottom-right, always visible, pulse animation
- Quick Play: Random game button using playful accent color
- Emergency Exit: In intense sessions (safety feature), uses safe green

4.4 Information Display Components

Trust Thermometer:

- Container: 90% screen width, centered
- Track: #2D1B45 with 30% opacity, rounded ends
- Fill: Progress Gradient with liquid animation
- Value Display: Large percentage, Inter Bold, updates in real-time
- Weekly Change: Arrow using appropriate accent color (green for positive, etc.)
- Emotional Particles: Multiple accent colors floating in the liquid

Player Stats Bar (Top):

- Avatars: 40×40px with Connection Gradient ring
- XP/Level: Inter Mono, accent color based on level tier
- Streak: Fire icon using warm accent colors, animated when extended
- Online Status: Dot using connection-appropriate color

Daily Quest Card:

- Background: #2D1B45 with gradient overlay using quest type color
- Title: Inter Bold, white
- Reward: XP + special currency, Inter Mono, accent color
- Timer: Countdown, color shifts as time decreases
- CTA Button: Primary gradient or accent color based on quest type

Leaderboard (You vs Partner):

- Layout: Side-by-side comparison
- Metrics: 4 pillars each with appropriate color:
 - Trust: Progress Gradient
 - Romance: Rose Pink (#E16BA9)
 - Connection: Soft Violet (#B37DEC)
 - Vulnerability: Vibrant Pink (#FC0C84)
- Visual: Progress bars for each, crown icon for leader
- Update: Real-time animations when scores change

4.5 Modal & Overlay Components

Emergency Modal (SOS):

- Background: Screen dims 70%, red overlay using multiple red/pink accents
- Content: #0F0A1F background with intense glow border
- Buttons: Large, high contrast, immediate feedback
- Animation: Quick slide-up, urgent but not panicky
- Colors: Red spectrum accents (#EA031F, #FC0C84, #FF6B9D)

Standard Modal:

- Background: #0F0A1F with blur
- Content: #2D1B45 with gradient border using modal context color
- Buttons: Primary gradient for confirm, accent color for cancel
- Animation: Gentle scale-up with fade
- Title: Accent color based on modal purpose

Toast Notifications:

- Position: Top slide-down
- Background: Semi-transparent using appropriate accent color
- Border: Glow matching background color
- Icon: Matching accent color
- Duration: 3 seconds auto-dismiss
- Types:
 - Success: #37CF97 (Mint Green)
 - Warning: #FFEF1F (Bright Yellow)
 - Info: #00D4AA (Aqua Teal)

- Error: #EA031F (Soft Red from gradient)
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V. SCREEN TEMPLATES & LAYOUTS

5.1 Universal Game Runner Template

Header (All Games):

text

GAME TITLE (Inter Bold, 24px)	 2:30
[Pause Button - accent color]	
Header BG: Gradient or accent color	

Content Area (Dynamic by Game Type):

text

TEXT INPUT:

- Multi-line field with gradient or accent border
- Character counter (accent color)
- Emotion detection hints (matching emotion color)
- Dr. Marcie leans on edge

VOICE RECORDING:

- Large button using voice-appropriate color
- Waveform visualization (multiple accent colors)
- Playback controls (timeline with progress gradient)

CAMERA INPUT:

- Live feed with face detection overlay (accent color)
- Capture button (large, glowing with action color)
- Preview thumbnail after capture

SLIDERS:

- Track using progress gradient or context color
- Glowing thumb (accent color)
- Numerical display above thumb (matching color)

- Labels at min/max points

AR FILTERS:

- Face filter carousel (various accent colors)
- Voice modulation toggle (sound-appropriate color)
- Record/playback controls

TOUCH CANVAS:

- Drawing tools palette (all 10 accent colors)
- Color selection based on emotional palette
- Clear/undo buttons (appropriate action colors)

Results Screen (All Games):

text

SCORE DISPLAY:

- Large animated number (victory-appropriate color)
- XP earned (counting animation with gold/yellow)
- Trust Meter change (+% animated with progress gradient)

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Badge unlock animation (multiple accent colors)
- Description pop-up (matching badge color)
- Share option (social-appropriate color)

DR. MARCIE COMMENTARY:

- Final thoughts in speech bubble (her UI color)
- Personality-appropriate reaction
- Connection to relationship growth

NAVIGATION:

- Play Again (primary gradient)
- Try Different Game (playful accent color)
- Return to Home (text link with neutral color)

5.2 Home Dashboard Layout

text

TOP (20%):

[Avatar Ring - Connection Gradient] [Partner Avatar]

[XP: 1245 - level-appropriate color] [Lvl 12] [ 7 - warm colors]

CENTER (40%):

[TRUST THERMOMETER - Progress Gradient]

[Weekly Change: +15% ↑ - growth color]

BELOW (40% scrollable):

[DAILY QUEST CARD - type-appropriate colors]

[LEADERBOARD - pillar-appropriate colors]

[7 CATEGORY CARDS - various accent colors]

FLOATING:

[SOS Button - emergency red gradient]

[Dr. Marcie Daily Roast - her character colors]

5.3 Game Library Layout

text

SEARCH BAR (Top):

[ Search games... - neutral color] [Filter icon - accent color]

FEATURED (20%):

[LOVE ARCADE - promotional with multiple colors]

[Phase progress - progress gradient]

CATEGORIES (60%):

[7 Category Cards - each with different accent color]

[Progress: 8/25 - progress gradient]

[Lock icon if premium - gold/yellow]

RECOMMENDED (20%):

[AI-curated games - context-appropriate colors]

[Quick Play random button - playful color]

5.4 SOS Fight Solver Layouts

Split-Screen Booths:

text

TIMER: 4:30 - urgency color	
MY SIDE	THEIR SIDE
Emotional color	Emotional color
[Frosted Glass]	[Frosted Glass]
[Text Area]	[Text Area]
"Private"	"Private"

Mad Libs Input:

text

I feel [▼ Dropdown - emotion-appropriate color]

When my partner [Text input - action-appropriate color]

Because I tell myself [Text input - thought-appropriate color]

What I actually need is [Text input - need-appropriate color]

[SUBMIT - Gradient or emotion-appropriate color]

AI Verdict Display:

text

WHAT YOU DID RIGHT:

[Alex: Good 'I feel' statement +10 VP - positive color]

[Animation: Points floating up]

THE CALL-OUT:

[Jordan: Stonewalling detected -15 CP - constructive color]

[Animation: Points floating down]

THE REALITY CHECK:

["You're fighting about dishes, but the issue is respect."]

[Styled as important quote - insight color]

WHO OWES APOLOGY:

[Jordan → Alex] [With handshake icon - resolution color]

REPAIR OPTIONS (Card selection):

[Option 1 - repair color 1]
[Option 2 - repair color 2]
[Option 3 - repair color 3]
[10:00 timer - urgency color]

5.5 Profile & Settings Layout

text

AVATAR SECTION (Top):

[Large avatar with Connection Gradient ring]
[Edit photo button - accent color]

STATS OVERVIEW:

[4 Pillar scores - each with pillar color]
[Weekly/Monthly change - growth/decline colors]

PERSONALITY SETTINGS:

[Dr. Marcie Level Selector - personality-appropriate colors]
[Sarcasm Filter slider - humor-appropriate gradient]
[Consequence Engine toggle - accountability color]

ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT:

[Subscription status - value-appropriate colors]
[Partner connection: SYNC ACTIVE - connection color]
[Data export/delete - neutral colors]

ACCESSIBILITY:

[Text size slider - clarity color]
[Colorblind mode - vision-appropriate colors]
[Reduce motion - comfort color]
[High contrast mode - clarity colors]

VI. MOTION DESIGN & ANIMATION SYSTEM

6.1 Timing & Duration Standards

- Micro-interactions: 200-300ms (button presses, toggles)
- State transitions: 300-400ms (screen changes, modal opens)

- Celebrations: 500-700ms (confetti, achievement unlocks)
- Loading sequences: <3s total with progress indication
- Real-time updates: <2s sync between devices

6.2 Easing Curves

- Standard UI: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0.0, 0.2, 1) - Smooth acceleration
- Entry animations: cubic-bezier(0.0, 0.0, 0.2, 1) - Quick start
- Exit animations: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0.0, 1, 1) - Quick finish
- Bounce/Playful: cubic-bezier(0.68, -0.55, 0.27, 1.55) - For celebrations
- Emotional moments: cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.8, 0.2, 1) - Slow, thoughtful

6.3 Specific Animation Implementations

Button Press:

1. Scale to 95% (100ms)
2. Darken fill by 20%
3. Return to 100% with overshoot to 102% (elastic, 50ms)
4. Haptic: Light tap
5. Color: Maintains its color identity throughout

Game Element Selection:

1. Outline glow intensifies (100ms) - same color family
2. Fill animates from center outward (200ms) - maintaining color
3. Text color transitions to white (150ms)
4. Subtle bounce on complete (50ms overshoot)
5. Color consistency maintained

Trust Thermometer Update:

1. New width calculates (instant)
2. Liquid fill animates smoothly (400ms) - progress gradient maintained
3. Wave effect travels along surface - multiple accent colors in wave
4. Percentage counter animates incrementally - color matches progress
5. Particle burst at new level milestones - celebratory accent colors

Screen Transitions:

- Push: Slide left/right with color-matched parallax (400ms)
- Modal: Scale up with color-matched fade (300ms)

- Tab switch: Cross-fade with icon color animation (200ms)
- Emergency (SOS): Quick dim + red-accented slide-up (200ms)

Feedback Animations:

- Success: Confetti burst using multiple celebratory colors, green glow pulse
- Failure: Gentle shake, color desaturates slightly, soft bounce
- Notification: Slide-down with notification-appropriate color, attention pulse
- Loading: Pulsing using element's color, progress bar maintains color identity

6.4 Performance Requirements

- Frame Rate: 60fps maintained on mid-range devices
 - Memory: No animation memory leaks, cleanup on unmount
 - Battery: Efficient animation scheduling, off when backgrounded
 - Network: Progressive loading, cached animations after first load
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VII. ACCESSIBILITY & INCLUSIVE DESIGN

7.1 Visual Accessibility

- Text Scaling: Dynamic scaling up to 200% without breaking layouts
- High Contrast Mode: Simplified backgrounds, stronger edges, maintains color emotionality
- Colorblind Modes: Adjusts palette while maintaining emotional temperature of colors
- Reduce Motion: Option to minimize complex animations while keeping color transitions
- Focus Indicators: Clear visual focus using element's color family

7.2 Interaction Accessibility

- Touch Targets: Minimum 44×44px, spacing maintains visual rhythm
- Gesture Alternatives: All interactions have color-consistent alternatives
- Timing Adjustments: Option to extend timers without changing color feedback

- Audio Alternatives: Visual color indicators for all audio cues
- Haptic Customization: Adjust intensity while maintaining color-touch connection

7.3 Content Accessibility

- Screen Reader Support: Complete VoiceOver/TalkBack with color context descriptions
- Alt Text: Includes color emotional context for images and animations
- Transcripts: For all voice content with emotional tone indicators
- Logical Reading Order: Consistent, follows visual color hierarchy
- Language Support: Left-to-right with color emotional consistency

7.4 Cognitive & Emotional Accessibility

- Clear Instructions: Color-coded steps for complex games
- Safety Exits: Always-available with calming color indicators
- Content Warnings: Color-coded intensity indicators
- Pacing Controls: Adjustable speed maintains color rhythm
- Simplified Mode: Reduces visual complexity while keeping color emotionality

7.5 Implementation Checklist

text

- ☐ All text scales dynamically without color loss
 - ☐ Colorblind modes maintain emotional temperature
 - ☐ Screen readers describe color emotional context
 - ☐ Touch targets meet minimum size with color consistency
 - ☐ Focus states use element's color family
 - ☐ Animation reduction maintains color transitions
 - ☐ Audio cues have color-equivalent visuals
 - ☐ Error messages use constructive, not alarming colors
 - ☐ Loading states maintain brand color presence
 - ☐ Recovery paths use encouraging colors
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VIII. FEEDBACK & RESPONSE SYSTEM

8.1 Multi-Channel Feedback

Every user action receives triad feedback with color consistency:

- Visual: Color-appropriate change, animation, particle effect
- Audio: Context-appropriate sound that matches color emotionality
- Haptic: Subtle vibration that matches color intensity

8.2 Contextual Feedback Types

Success Feedback:

- Visual: Confetti using celebratory colors, color-appropriate glow pulse
- Audio: Ascending chime matching success color family
- Haptic: Light double-tap pattern
- Dr. Marcie: Celebratory animation + positive quip in her color style

Error/Needs Improvement:

- Visual: Gentle shake, color slightly desaturates, constructive color emphasis
- Audio: Soft descending tone in error-appropriate color family
- Haptic: Single heavier vibration
- Dr. Marcie: Constructive feedback in helpful colors

Warning/Attention:

- Visual: Attention color pulse, subtle bounce
- Audio: Attention chime in warning color family
- Haptic: Two quick vibrations
- Dr. Marcie: Points to issue with attention colors

Progress/Update:

- Visual: Smooth color transition, particle trail in progress colors
- Audio: Subtle progression sound matching update type
- Haptic: Light single tap
- Dr. Marcie: Nods approval with encouraging colors

8.3 Dr. Marcie's Feedback Integration

- Immediate: Reacts within 500ms with color-appropriate response
- Contextual: Feedback uses colors matching the interaction
- Personality-Adjusted: Tone and color emphasis match selected level
- Emotionally Intelligent: Color responses recognize emotional context
- Progress-Linked: References previous interactions with consistent colors

8.4 Loading & Wait States

- Under 1s: No indicator needed
 - 1-3s: Skeleton screen with brand color hints
 - 3-5s: Animated loading using context-appropriate colors
 - Over 5s: Progress bar + entertaining color-based distraction
 - Failed Load: Clear error with recovery options in constructive colors
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IX. USER FLOWS & INTERACTION PATTERNS

9.1 Onboarding Flow (First-Time Users)

text

1. SPLASH (3s)

- Animated neon logo with full color spectrum
- Tagline appears with gradient
- Background shows all 10 accent colors flowing

2. LEGAL MODAL

- Must-check agreement with attention colors
- Dr. Marcie: "Rules are rules, darling." in her colors

3. AUTHENTICATION

- New/Returning with welcoming colors
- Email/password with secure colors
- Biometric with futuristic colors

4. ORIGIN STORY (4 Steps)

- Text/voice with Marcie reactions in appropriate colors

- Sliders with emotional intensity colors
- Movie reference with cinematic colors
- Character class selection with personality colors

5. COUPLE LINKING

- Code generation with connection colors
- Share options with social colors
- Partner entry with validation colors
- Celebration: Confetti in celebration colors

9.2 Daily Engagement Flow

text

OPEN APP (1 tap):

- Home dashboard loads with welcoming colors
- Dr. Marcie daily roast in her character colors
- Trust Thermometer animates with progress colors

DAILY QUEST (1 tap):

- Tap card with quest-type colors
- "ACCEPT" in primary action gradient
- Game launches with game-appropriate colors

GAME PLAY (Variable):

- Universal template with context colors
- Input methods with interaction colors
- Real-time feedback with response colors
- Results with achievement colors

POST-GAME (1 tap):

- Return with navigation colors
- Leaderboard updates with competitive colors
- Trust Thermometer adjusts with relationship colors

9.3 SOS Emergency Flow

text

TRIGGER (1 tap):

- Floating SOS button in emergency colors

- Emergency modal in urgent colors

BOOTHS (5 min):

- Split-screen with emotional venting colors
- Timer in urgency colors
- Structured input with emotional labeling colors

MAD LIBS (Complete):

- Emotion dropdown with emotion colors
- Text inputs with context colors
- Submit when both ready in resolution colors

VERDICT (AI Generated):

- What went right/wrong in constructive colors
- Reality check in insight colors
- Apology direction in resolution colors

REPAIR (10 min):

- 3 option cards in repair colors
- Timer in urgency colors
- Post-repair in reflection colors

9.4 Partner Translator Flow

text

INPUT (Type):

- Chat-style with conversation colors
- Confusion question in curiosity colors

INTERROGATION (3 Questions):

- Rapid-fire with detective colors
- Timer in urgency colors
- Dr. Marcie as detective in mystery colors

TRANSLATION (Reveal):

- Card flip with revelation colors
- Surface → Real → Need layers in insight colors
- "Ah-ha!" moment in breakthrough colors

ACTION PLAN:

- Specific quest with action colors
- Reward promise in incentive colors
- Follow-up reminder in reminder colors

9.5 Love Arcade Progression

text

ENTRANCE:

- Retro arcade with nostalgic colors
- 4 phase selection with progression colors
- Cabinet gallery with game-appropriate colors

PHASE PROGRESSION:

- Complete games with achievement colors
- Narrative connections with story colors
- Boss fight with challenge colors

COMPLETION:

- Trophy room with achievement colors
 - Special Dr. Marcie outfit in celebration colors
 - Next phase available in anticipation colors
-

X. DOs & DON'Ts (UI/UX SPECIFIC)

UI/UX DOs:

Color Application:

- Use all 10 accent colors freely throughout the entire app
- Apply gradients for primary actions and progress
- Let colors flow based on emotional context, not rigid rules
- Maintain color consistency within each component's identity
- Use background colors to set emotional tone
- Create color rhythm and flow across the experience

Dr. Marcie Consistency:

- Keep her red hair always red (signature crimson)

- Maintain her 1950s noir detective aesthetic
- Use consistent character animation style (never anime/2D flat)
- Allow costume changes but not character redesign
- Ensure her colors work with any app color context
- Make her interactions color-appropriate to context

Interaction Design:

- Provide immediate color-appropriate feedback (under 100ms)
- Maintain 3-tap navigation with clear color coding
- Design for thumb-zone with color hierarchy
- Include color-coded recovery paths from errors
- Offer multiple input methods with consistent color coding
- Ensure touch targets have clear color states

Animation & Motion:

- Animate color transitions smoothly (300-400ms)
- Use color-appropriate easing (emotional context matters)
- Maintain 60fps with color animations
- Provide haptic feedback matching color intensity
- Include loading distractions using brand colors
- Allow animation reduction while keeping color transitions

Accessibility:

- Support dynamic text scaling with color consistency
- Provide colorblind modes that maintain emotional temperature
- Include screen reader color context descriptions
- Offer motion reduction with color state preservation
- Ensure keyboard navigation has color focus states
- Provide alternative inputs with same color coding

✗ UI/UX DON'Ts:

Color Application:

- ✗ Assign fixed meanings to specific colors
- ✗ Use colors without emotional consideration
- ✗ Create color combinations that feel clinical or harsh
- ✗ Forget color consistency within user flows

- ✗ Use colors that don't work in colorblind modes
- ✗ Create low contrast that loses emotional impact

Dr. Marcie Consistency:

- ✗ Change her red hair color ever
- ✗ Convert her animation style to anime or 2D flat
- ✗ Alter her core 1950s noir detective aesthetic
- ✗ Make her outfits clash with app color philosophy
- ✗ Let her colors feel disconnected from context
- ✗ Allow inconsistent character proportions

Interaction Design:

- ✗ Create dead-end screens without color-coded exits
- ✗ Require more than 3 taps with confusing color paths
- ✗ Make touch targets with unclear color states
- ✗ Hide critical functions without color indicators
- ✗ Use inconsistent color patterns across similar actions
- ✗ Trap users without color-coded escape options

Animation & Motion:

- ✗ Animate colors in jarring or uncomfortable ways
- ✗ Use animations that don't match color emotionality
- ✗ Make loading feel indefinite without color progress
- ✗ Create motion that conflicts with color meaning
- ✗ Forget to respect reduced motion color preferences
- ✗ Animate critical info with distracting color changes

Accessibility:

- ✗ Rely solely on color without other indicators
- ✗ Use autoplay without color-based controls
- ✗ Create timed actions without color time indicators
- ✗ Forget keyboard color focus testing
- ✗ Ignore screen reader color context testing
- ✗ Make error messages with alarming colors only

Emotional Safety:

- ✗ Make failure feel punitive with harsh colors

-  Use colors that trigger negative associations
 -  Create pressure with anxiety-inducing colors
 -  Forget safety exits with calming color indicators
 -  Ignore content warnings with appropriate color coding
 -  Make comparisons with competitive, divisive colors
-

XI. IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLISTS

11.1 Screen Implementation Checklist

For every screen (105+ total), verify:

text

COLOR CONSISTENCY:

- ☐ Colors flow emotionally across the screen
- ☐ Gradients used for primary actions and progress
- ☐ Accent colors create emotional rhythm
- ☐ Background colors set appropriate emotional tone
- ☐ Text colors maintain readability with emotionality
- ☐ Interactive elements have clear color states

DR. MARCIE INTEGRATION:

- ☐ Her red hair and character style maintained
- ☐ Positioning doesn't block critical color elements
- ☐ Her colors work with screen color context
- ☐ Animations match her consistent character style
- ☐ Personality settings affect her but not her design
- ☐ She enhances rather than distracts from color flow

INTERACTION DESIGN:

- ☐ Clear primary CTA with appropriate gradient
- ☐ Touch targets have clear color states
- ☐ Color-coded feedback for all interactions
- ☐ Error states use constructive, not alarming colors
- ☐ Navigation uses consistent color coding

ACCESSIBILITY:

- ☐ Text scales without losing color emotionality

- ☐ Colorblind modes maintain emotional temperature
- ☐ Screen readers describe color emotional context
- ☐ Focus states use element's color family
- ☐ Motion reduction preserves color transitions

PERFORMANCE:

- ☐ Color animations smooth (60fps)
- ☐ Gradients render without banding
- ☐ Color transitions efficient
- ☐ Memory efficient with color assets
- ☐ Battery optimized for color animations

11.2 Component Implementation Checklist

For each UI component type:

text

COLOR-DRIVEN COMPONENTS:

- ☐ Primary buttons use action gradient
- ☐ Secondary buttons use context-appropriate accent colors
- ☐ Progress elements use progress gradient or growth colors
- ☐ Status indicators use emotion-appropriate colors
- ☐ Game elements use playful, context-appropriate colors
- ☐ Information displays use clarity-appropriate colors

DR. MARCIE ELEMENTS:

- ☐ Her character design consistent (red hair, 1950s style)
- ☐ Her UI elements use her character-appropriate colors
- ☐ Animations maintain her character animation style
- ☐ Outfits can change but not core design
- ☐ Personality affects dialogue/color emphasis, not design
- ☐ She never blocks critical color interactions

INTERACTION STATES:

- ☐ Default state clearly visible with appropriate color
- ☐ Hover/active state intensifies or shifts color appropriately
- ☐ Pressed state shows color feedback
- ☐ Disabled state reduces opacity but maintains color identity
- ☐ Success/error states use constructive colors

ANIMATION & FEEDBACK:

- ☐ Color transitions smooth and emotionally appropriate
- ☐ Feedback uses color-appropriate animations
- ☐ Loading states maintain brand color presence
- ☐ Celebrations use celebratory color combinations
- ☐ Error recovery uses encouraging colors

11.3 Color System Verification Checklist

For the unified color system:

text

EMOTIONAL CONSISTENCY:

- ☐ Colors create appropriate emotional atmosphere
- ☐ Color combinations feel harmonious, not chaotic
- ☐ Emotional temperature matches screen purpose
- ☐ Color transitions feel natural, not jarring
- ☐ Color rhythm supports user flow
- ☐ Colors enhance, rather than distract from, content

IMPLEMENTATION QUALITY:

- ☐ Gradients render smoothly on all devices
- ☐ Accent colors distinguishable in all contexts
- ☐ Color combinations work in all lighting conditions
- ☐ Text remains readable against all color backgrounds
- ☐ Interactive elements clearly distinguishable
- ☐ Color hierarchy supports information architecture

ACCESSIBILITY VERIFICATION:

- ☐ Colorblind modes maintain emotional intent
- ☐ High contrast mode preserves color relationships
- ☐ Reduced motion maintains color state clarity
- ☐ Screen readers describe color emotional context
- ☐ All color information has non-color backups
- ☐ Color use enhances rather than hinders accessibility

DR. MARCIE COLOR INTEGRATION:

- ☐ Her colors work with any app color context
- ☐ Her character colors remain consistent
- ☐ Her UI elements use appropriate accent colors

- ☐ She enhances color emotionality of scenes
- ☐ Her animations respect app color philosophy
- ☐ Her personality affects color emphasis appropriately